DOCUMENT

05

User Guide

Using the web interface, step by step

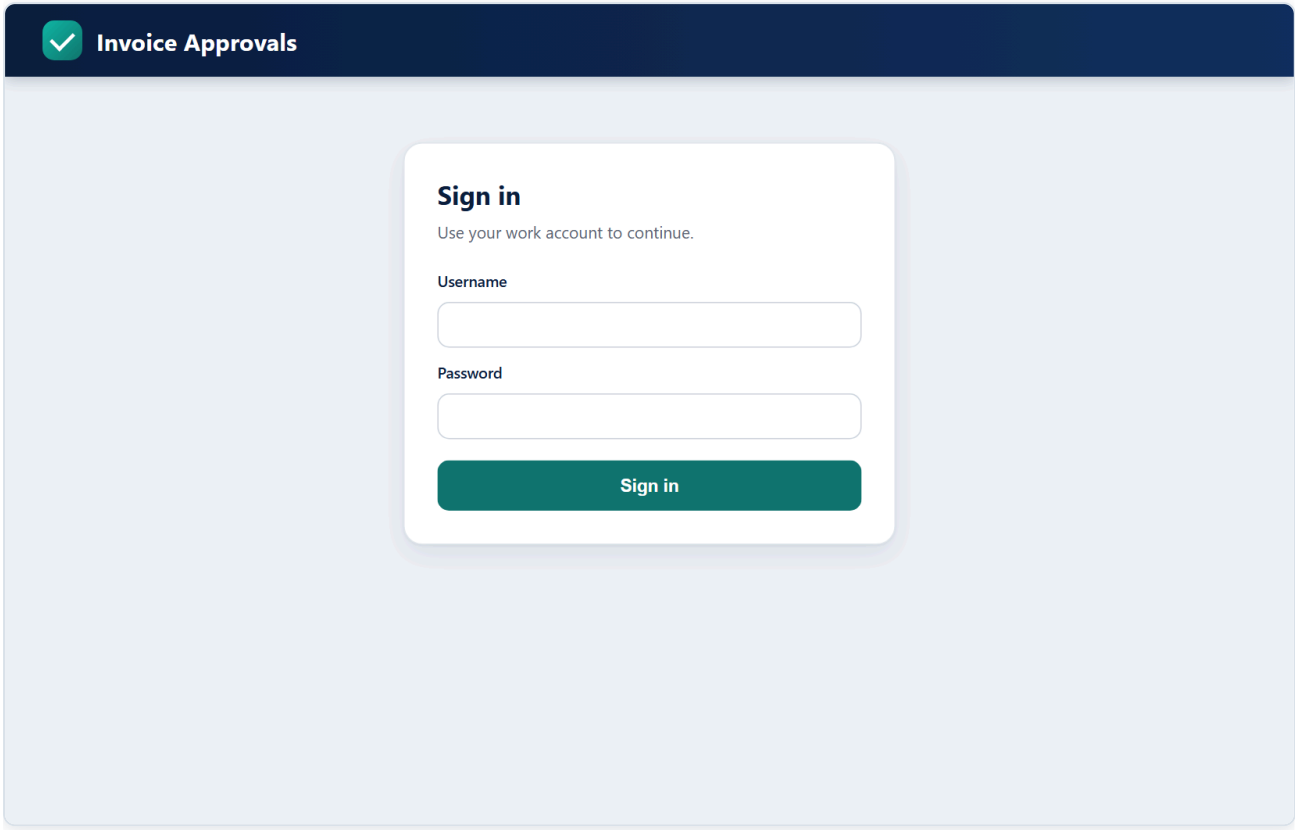
This guide is for the people who create and approve invoices in the web UI.

1. Starting the app

```
pip install -e "backend[dev]"
python -m uvicorn invoice_app.api.main:app --app-dir backend/src --port 5000
```

Open http://localhost:5000. Data lives in memory: restarting the server resets everything to the demo data.

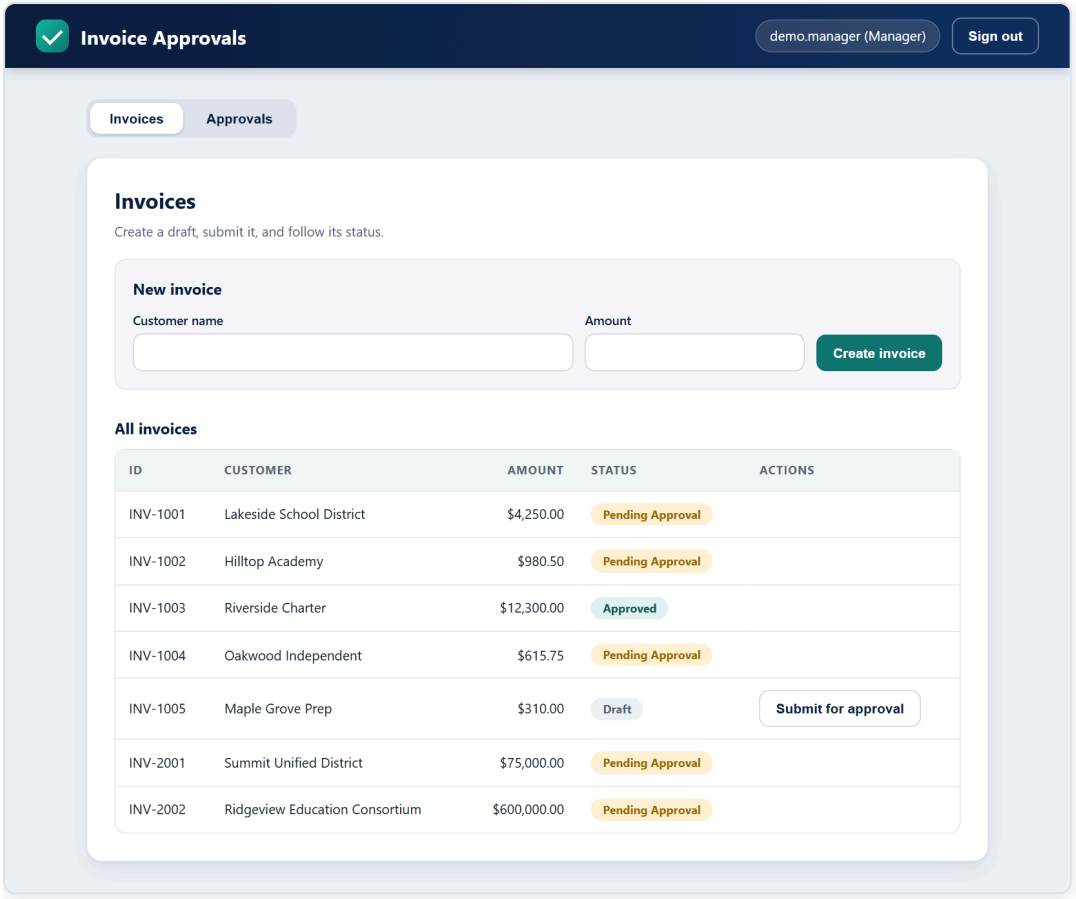
2. Signing in



Use one of the demo accounts (password `ChangeMe123!` for all):

Username	Role	What the role can do
`demo.manager`	Manager	Approve up to 50,000.00; give the first approval above 500,000.00
`demo.director`	Director	Approve up to 500,000.00 alone; give either approval above that
`demo.director2`	Director	Same as above; a second, different Director
`demo.admin`	Admin	Reject and delete invoices; **cannot approve**

3. The Invoices tab



The table lists every invoice with its customer, amount, status and actions. Use **New invoice** to add one (it starts as a Draft) and **Submit** to send a draft for approval. Statuses are Draft, Pending Approval, Approved and Rejected.

4. Approving an invoice

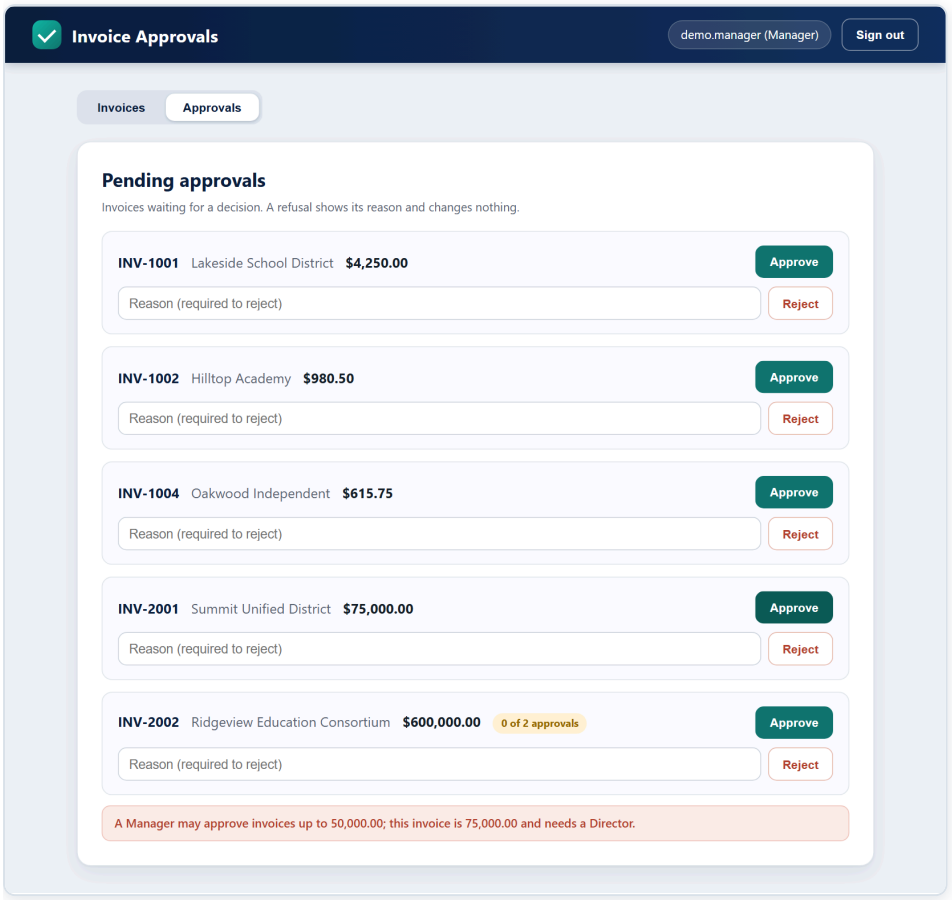
Open the **Approvals** tab to see everything waiting for a decision. Each entry has an **Approve** button and a **Reject** button with a reason field.

4.1 Who may approve what

Invoice amount	Who may approve	Approvals needed
up to 50,000.00	Manager or Director	1
50,000.01 to 500,000.00	Director	1
above 500,000.00	first: Manager or Director; second: Director	2 different people

4.2 When you are refused

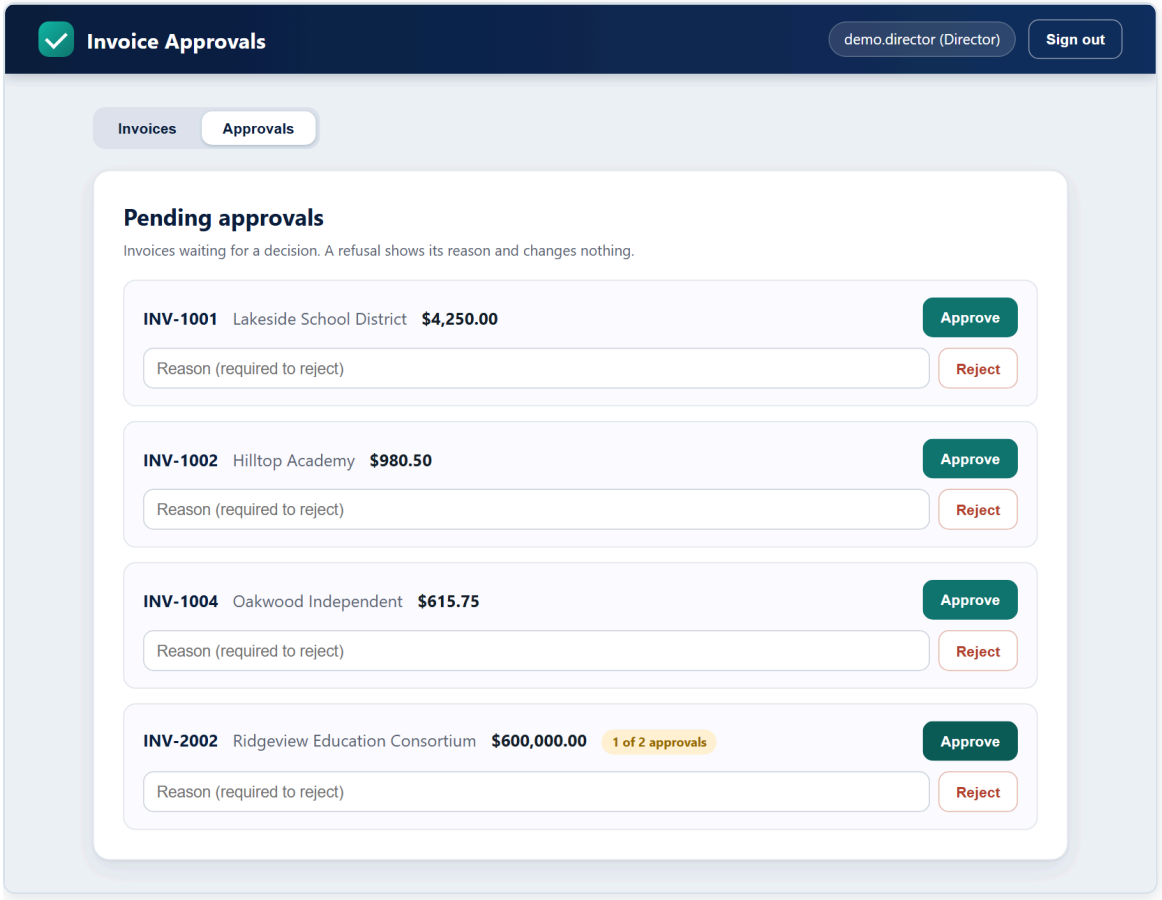
If you press Approve and the rules do not allow it, a red message tells you why and **the invoice is left exactly as it was**. For example, a Manager on the 75,000.00 invoice (INV-2001):



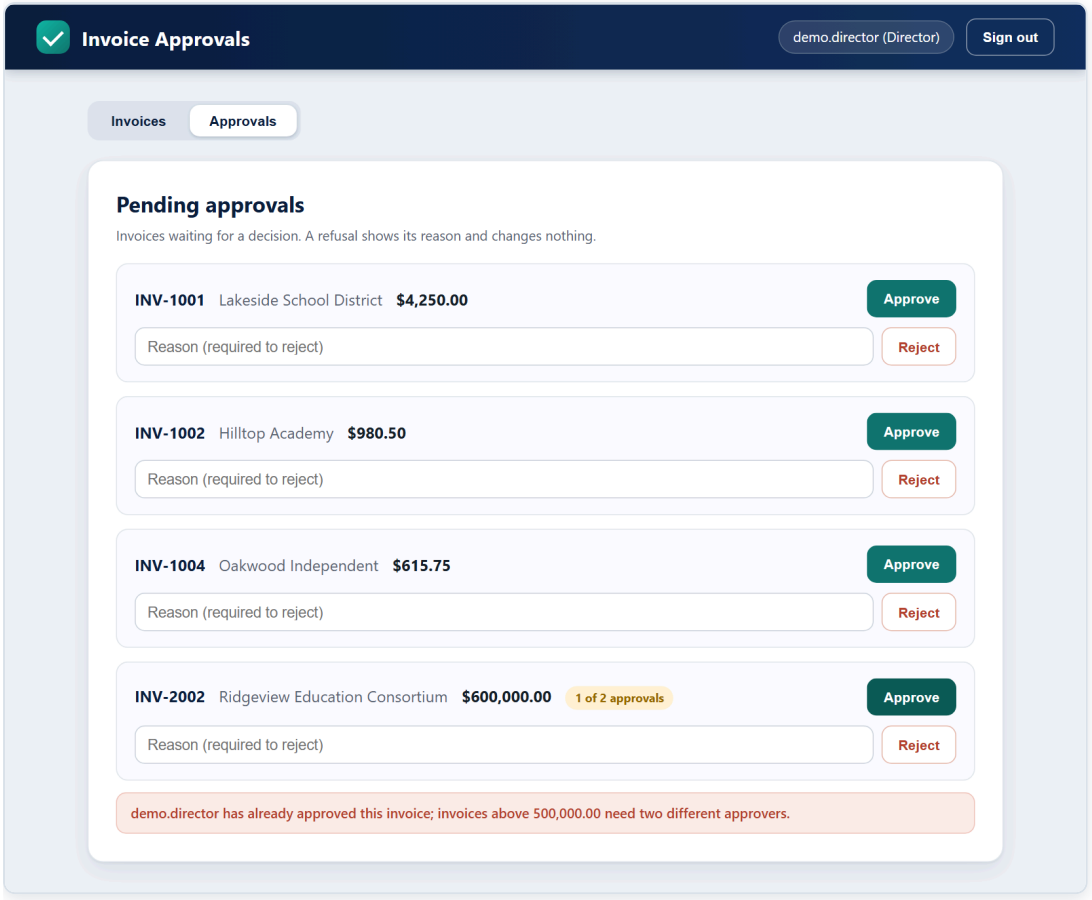
The same applies if you are the wrong role, or you try to approve twice.

4.3 Invoices that need two approvals

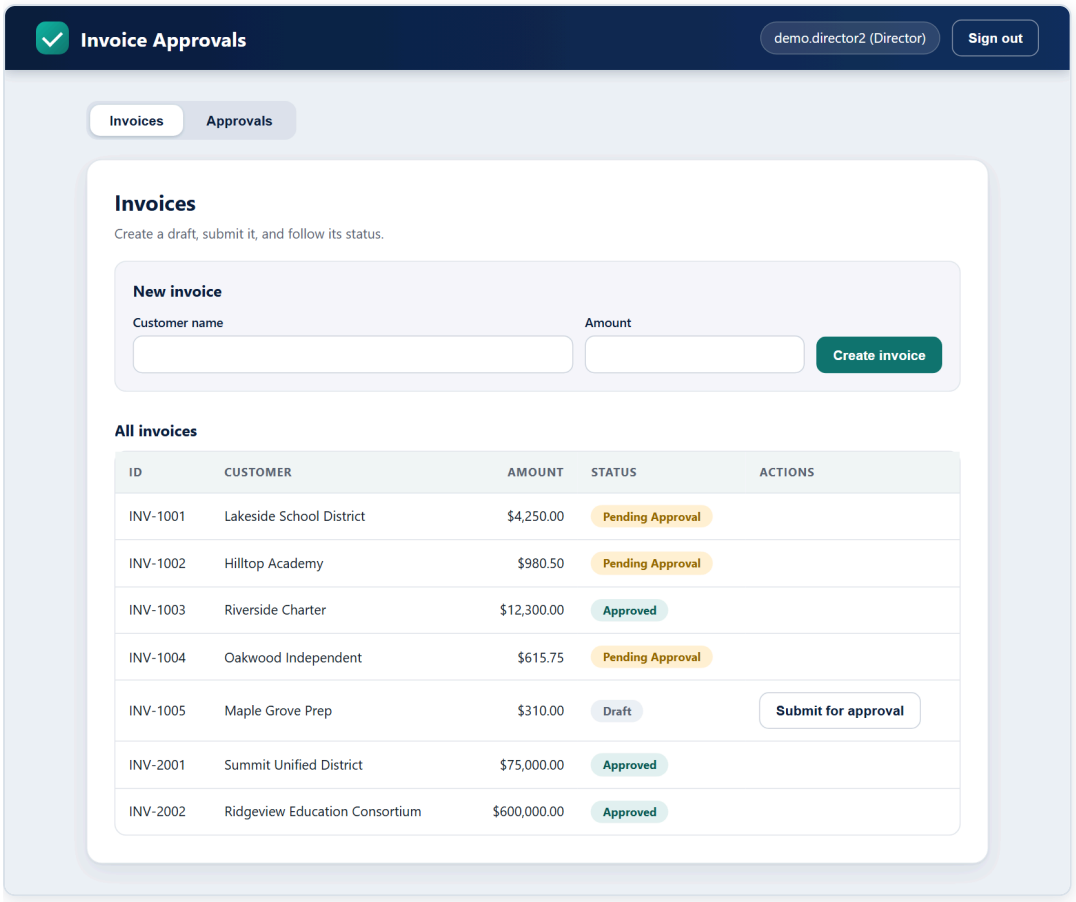
An invoice above 500,000.00 (the demo has INV-2002 at 600,000.00) stays pending after the first approval and shows **1 of 2 approvals**:



The same person cannot give the second approval, even if their name is typed with different capitals or spaces:



A different Director completes it, and the invoice becomes Approved:



5. Rejecting an invoice

Type a reason in the field next to **Reject** and press the button. A reason is required. Rejecting works on any pending invoice, including one that already has its first approval.

6. Try it yourself: a 3-minute walkthrough

1. Sign in as `demo.manager`, open Approvals, press Approve on INV-2001 (75,000.00). Read the refusal; the invoice stays pending.
2. Sign out, sign in as `demo.director`, approve INV-2001. It becomes Approved.
3. Still as `demo.director`, approve INV-2002 (600,000.00). It shows 1 of 2 approvals.
4. Press Approve on INV-2002 again. You are refused: you already approved it.
5. Sign out, sign in as `demo.director2`, approve INV-2002. It becomes Approved.

7. Frequently asked questions

Why can an Admin not approve? Admin is an administrative role (reject, delete). Approval authority belongs to Managers and Directors only.

Is 50,000.00 exactly allowed for a Manager? Yes. The limits are inclusive: 50,000.00 is allowed, 50,000.01 is not.

Does a refused attempt leave a trace? No. Nothing about the invoice changes: not the status, the approver, the time or the list of approvals.

I approved the first half and changed my mind. Any pending invoice can still be rejected with a reason.